

There is no doubt that AI is still in its childhood, but it has reached a critical mass, where research as well as application can happen simultaneously. We can undoubtedly say that we have changed gears.

AI is already making several decisions that affect our life, whether we like it or not, and has covered significant ground in recent years.

AI is not everywhere yet

While it would be natural to think that AI has penetrated almost every single vertical or market, this is far from the truth. At best, there are only a few technology spot-fires in a few select industries where AI is making its mark.

Unfortunately, as always, marketing gimmicks are at play to make everyone feel that AI has covered everything, while several sections are still untouched.

Many image-recognition systems are now better at detecting cancer or micro-fractures from a patient's MRI or X-ray reports. Many pattern-recognition systems can correlate several pathological reports and make

an almost precise prediction of the health status of the patient. And yet, medical recommendations without a doctor's explicit approval is not a commonplace practice. And this is good, because, when there is human life at stake, systems should not make a final call, ever. Therefore as far as the medical field is concerned, AI might only reach a status of assisted intelligence and may not be permitted (should not be allowed) to become a mainstream phenomenon at all.

While companies are continually taking humans out of the customer service sector and replacing them with chatbots or automated responders that are AI-driven, human touch is becoming expensive. At an event that saw startups pitching their company/product, one startup's primary differentiation was that it provided personal support for all queries. Mostly, we are seeing an exciting shift in terms of AI- and non-AI-based offerings.

Self-learning applications is another area where AI is making an entry. Using customised learning, pace and recommendations, it is becoming quite popular. However, as that happens,

teaching, coaching and mentoring will soon become a high touch service and still be in demand. Therefore it is difficult to say whether AI has touched this sector truly or just morphed it into something else.

Another area where AI has not yet touched and might not affect is live entertainment and art. These are such personalised and creative pursuits that without having a human in it, they would not have the same meaning. There have been a few experiments with AI creating art, but those art forms have quite a different flavour to them. AI systems can create art based on what they have been trained for. Several of those are mainly geometrical and systematic shapes or pictures—nothing that a human would necessarily draw with a slightly acceptable and natural imbalance in it. Real authorship of the work of art cannot be yet bestowed to an artificial system.

Creativity is some part process and some part randomness, which is the exact opposite of the rule-based method. It is not likely for AI to be able to contribute directly to the creative industry any time soon.



AI-driven automated responders or chatbots